SANDANI PIYASENA

French Language Educator | French Immersion Teacher Candidate

Coquitlam, BC · +1 778 302 0668 · sandani.cham@gmail.com · www.sandani.ca

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

French language educator with three years of secondary-school teaching experience and a Bachelor of Arts in French (DALF C1). Completing the Bachelor of Education (minor in French Education) and the Professional Development Program, French Immersion module, at Simon Fraser University, with a major practicum at École Salish Secondary, teaching New Media 11 and Social Studies 8. BC teaching certificate (Teacher Regulation Branch) in process, awaiting final practicum report. Experienced in lesson planning, assessment, and working with students and families in an inclusive classroom. Seeking French and French Immersion teaching positions, including teacher-on-call, with Lower Mainland school districts.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

Bachelor of Education (B.Ed.), Minor in French Education — Expected December 2026
Simon Fraser University, British Columbia

Professional Development Program (PDP), French Immersion Module — In progress
Simon Fraser University, British Columbia

- BC teaching certificate (Teacher Regulation Branch): in process, awaiting final practicum report.

Master of Business Administration (part-time) — Sep 2019 – Jun 2021
University of Bedfordshire, United Kingdom

Bachelor of Arts in French Language — Feb 2015 – Mar 2019
University of Kelaniya, Sri Lanka

French: DALF C1, French Ministry of National Education
English: IELTS General Training – Listening 8.0, Reading 8.5, Writing 7.0, Speaking 7.5

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Student Teacher, Major Practicum — Oct 2026 – Dec 2026
École Salish Secondary, Surrey, BC (SFU PDP, French Immersion module)

- Planned and taught lessons in New Media 11 and Social Studies 8, working within the BC curriculum.
- Designed activities and assessments linked to BC curricular and core competencies.
- Incorporated Indigenous perspectives and inclusive practices to support diverse learners.

French Teacher, Secondary School — Jun 2021 – Jun 2024
Gateway College, Dehiwala, Sri Lanka

- Planned and delivered French lessons aligned with Pearson Edexcel standards.
- Assessed student learning and monitored progress to inform instruction and support achievement.
- **Grade 9 Coordinator and Class Teacher (Jul 2023 – Jun 2024):** coordinated curriculum delivery, assessment and communication with teachers, students and families.
- **House Mistress:** supervised student welfare and behaviour, and organized inter-house competitions, sports events and cultural celebrations to promote participation and school spirit.

RELATED EXPERIENCE

Sales and Reservations Supervisor — Sep 2019 – Sep 2020
Mai Globe Travels

- Led sales and reservations staff, set schedules, trained new employees and resolved cross-department issues.
- Collaborated with other departments to address and resolve work-related issues.
- Accountable for customer satisfaction; stepped in during urgent situations to maintain continuity.

Tour Executive Feb 2019 – Aug 2019
Luxe Asia (Pvt) Ltd.

- Designed tailored travel programs for French-speaking clients and prepared cost estimates.
- Resolved issues during tours and prepared client packets with itineraries, maps and essential information.

VOLUNTEER & LEADERSHIP

Volunteer English Teacher 2016
Assumption University, Thailand

- Taught pupils from underserved communities using problem-based learning; prepared course outlines to curriculum guidance and met with parents about student progress.

Vice President, Outgoing Global Talent (2016–2017); Team Leader (2016) 2016 – 2017
AIESEC Colombo North, University of Kelaniya

- Led and supported team members, developed international partnerships, and ran recruitment, presentations and marketing for global placements.

SKILLS

Teaching: French language instruction · BC curriculum and core competencies · lesson planning · assessment and progress monitoring · classroom management · curriculum coordination

Students and families: inclusive education · Indigenous perspectives · culturally responsive practice · student motivation · family communication · conflict resolution

Tools: Microsoft Office · Microsoft Teams · Power Apps · ChatGPT for educators

REFERENCES

Natalie Kidwell – French Immersion Teacher, École Salish Secondary
kidwell_n@surreyschools.ca | +1 604 754 5915

Dr. Cécile Bullock – Professor, Faculty of Education, Simon Fraser University
cecile_bullock@sfu.ca

Isabelle Côté – Senior Lecturer, Faculty of Education, Simon Fraser University
isabelle_cote_education@sfu.ca

Maheesha Morris – Head of Key Stage 4 (Grade 10, 11) Gateway College Dehiwala - Sri Lanka
Maheesha.kariyawasam@gateway.ca | +94 77 312 3322